

following rules can effectively help to improve Linux's performance on your system.

For normal servers:

- Swap space should be equal to RAM size if RAM size is less than 2 GB.
- Swap space should be equal to 2 GB if RAM size is greater than 2 GB.

For heavy duty servers with fast storage requirements:

- Swap space should be equal to RAM size if RAM size is less than 8 GB.
- Swap space should be equal to 0.5 times the size of the RAM if the RAM size is greater than 8 GB.

If you have already installed Linux, you can check your swap space by using the following command in the Linux terminal:

```
cat /proc/swaps
```

Swappiness and how to change it

Swappiness is a parameter that controls the tendency of the kernel to transfer the processes from physical memory to 'swap space'. It has a value between 0 to 100 and in Ubuntu, it has a default value of 60. To check the swappiness value, use the following command:

```
cat /proc/sys/vm/swappiness
```

A temporary change (lost at reboot) in a swappiness value of 10, for example, can be done with the following command:

```
sudo sysctl vm.swappiness=10
```

For a permanent change, edit the configuration file as follows:

```
gksudo gedit /etc/sysctl.conf
```

If the swappiness value is 0, then the kernel restricts the swapping process; and if the value is 100, the kernel swaps very aggressively.

So, while Linux as an operating system has great powers, you should know how to use those powers effectively so that you can improve the performance of your system. **END** 

By: Roopak T J

The author is an open source contributor and enthusiast. He has contributed to a couple of open source organisations including Mediawiki and LibreOffice. He is currently in his second year at Amrita University (B. Tech). You can contact him at mailstoprk@gmail.com

support@ efyindia.com

**Do you have a query,
suggestion or a complaint?**

**You can e-mail it to
support@efyindia.com
and we will take care
of the rest.**

